

Sherry Rui Xiong

Department of Psychology, New York University

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[Google scholar](#)

EDUCATION

- 2023-2028 **New York University, United States**
PhD in Social Psychology
- 2018-2022 **Nanyang Technological University, Singapore**
Bachelor of Social Sciences in Psychology and Media Analytics, Honors (Highest Distinction)

HONORS & AWARDS

- 2026 **Conference Travel Award**, Society for the Science of Motivation
- 2025 **LMU-NYU Research Cooperation Program Fellowship**, New York University (\$8,000)
Funding for a research visit at Ludwig-Maximilians-University Munich
- 2025 **Graduate Student Existential Psychology Research Conference Award**, International Society for the Science of Existential Psychology
- 2025 **Graduate Registration Stipend Award**, Society for Personality and Social Psychology
- 2024, 2026 **GSAS Dean's Conference Fund**, New York University
- 2024 **Global Research Initiatives Fellowship**, New York University (~\$6,000)
Funding for a research visit at the NYU Center in Prague
- 2024 **Summer Research Fellowship**, New York University (\$6,000)
- 2024 **Dean's Supplementary Fellowship Grant** (\$1,000)
- 2023 - 2028 **MacCracken Fellowship**, New York University (full Ph.D. funding)
- 2022 **Regional Winner from Asia in the Psychology Category**, The Global Undergraduate Awards
- 2020 **Undergraduate Research Excellence Award**, Nanyang Technological University
- 2019, 2020 **Dean's List**, Nanyang Technological University
- 2018-2022 **Humanities, Arts and Social Sciences Scholarship**, Nanyang Technological University (~\$40,000)
- 2013-2017 **Senior Middle 1 Full Scholarship**, Ministry of Education, Singapore (~\$141,000)
Fully funded program for top international students; covered tuition, stipend, housing, and travel for study in Singapore

PUBLICATIONS

- Xiong, S. R.**, Ho, S. S., Tan, W., Li, B. J., & Lisak, G. (2024). Virtual environment, real impacts: A self-determination perspective on the use of virtual reality for pro-environmental behavior interventions. *Environmental Communication*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17524032.2024.2361270>
- Ho, S. S., **Xiong, S. R.**, Li, B. J., Tan, W., Ou, M., & Lisak, G. (2024). Encouraging pro-environmental behaviour in a virtual reality serious game: The interplay between competition and prior knowledge. *Behaviour & Information Technology*, 1–24. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0144929X.2024.2439528>
- Ho, S. S., **Xiong, R.**, & Chuah, A. S. F. (2021). Heuristic cues as perceptual filters: Factors influencing

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Xiong, S. R., & Balcetis, E. (*In preparation for Science*). From obstacles to successes: How media frames shape emotional and behavioral responses to gender disparity in leadership positions.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (*In preparation for Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*). Approaching anticipated endings: Certainty about what comes next promotes closure.

TALKS

Xiong, S. R. & Balcetis, E. (2026, May). *Being Real vs. Looking Good: How Authenticity Motive Constrains Self-Enhancing Emotional Expression*. Talk given at Six College Conference, Yale University.

Xiong, S. R. & Balcetis, E. (2026, May). *Perceived Diffusion of Attention: More Authentic Emotional Expression in a Group*. Flash talk given at Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, Barcelona.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2026, February). *Approaching an Anticipated Ending: Certainty About What Comes Next Promotes Closure*. Invited talk given at the Social Action Lab, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania.

Li, J., Landy, J., **Xiong, S. R.**, & Zonouz, M. N. (2025, July)¹. *An Agent-Based Model of Impression Management*. Project presentation at the Summer Institutes in Computational Social Science, University of Pennsylvania.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2025, May). *Secure the Future: Achieving Psychological Closure When Approaching an Anticipated Ending*. Data Blitz talk given at Six College Conference, New York University.

Xiong, S. R., Franco, M., & Balcetis, E. (2025). *From Disparity to Power: How Media Framing Shapes Responses to Gender Disparity in Leadership Roles*. Talk given at Global Urban Summit (Mini-conference: How Marginalized Identities See and Are Seen in Urban Environments), New York.

CONFERENCE POSTERS

Xiong, S. R. & Balcetis, E. (2026, May). *Dyadic Versus Group Interactions: A Dual Motive Account of Emotional Management*. Poster presented at Society for the Science of Motivation Annual Convention, Barcelona.

Xiong, S. R. & Balcetis, E. (2026, March). *Perceived Diffusion of Attention: More Authentic Emotional Expression in a Group than Dyad*. Poster presented at Society for Affective Science Annual Convention, Pittsburgh.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2026, February). *Approaching an Anticipated Ending: Certainty About What Comes Next Promotes Closure*. Poster presented at Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Chicago.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2025). *Facing a Foreseeable Ending: Future Focus Predicts Psychological Closure upon Life Transitions*. Poster presented at Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Denver.

Xiong, S. R., Franco, M., & Balcetis, E. (2025). *From Disparity to Power: How Media Framing Shapes Responses to Gender Disparity in Leadership Roles*. Poster presented at Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Denver.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2024). *Creating a Well-Rounded Ending: Strive for Meaning Instead of Emotional Satisfaction*. Poster presented at Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, San Francisco.

¹ Speakers listed in alphabetical order.

Xiong, S. R., Gollwitzer, P., & Oettingen, G. (2024). *Future Focus and Well-rounded Endings: Predicting Psychological Closure When Facing a Foreseeable Ending*. Poster presented at American Psychological Association Annual Convention, Seattle.

Xiong, R. (2022). *Why Am I Not Your Perfect Family Member? Causal Attribution Moderates the Impacts of Relational Self-Discrepancy*. Poster presented at Undergraduate Awards Global Summit 2022, Dublin.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2022-2023 **Full-time Research Assistant** (Advisor: Prof. Shirley S. Ho)
Wee Kim Wee School of Communication and Information, Nanyang Technological University
- Collaborated with a tech company in developing a VR game for environmental behavioral intervention
 - Led literature searches, experiment design, data analyses, and manuscript writing
- 2021-2022 **Honors Thesis – Psychology** (Advisor: Assoc Prof. Wan Ching)
Thesis Title: Why Am I Not Your Perfect Family Member? Causal Attribution Moderates the Impacts of Relational Self-Discrepancy
- 2021-2022 **Honors Thesis – Media Analytics** (Advisor: Asst Prof Poong Oh)
Thesis Title: A Turing Test Derivative: Understanding Public Trust in AI through Machine Learning
- 2019-2020 **President Research Scholar** (Advisor: Prof. Shirley S. Ho)
Undergraduate Research Experience on Campus Program, Nanyang Technological University

MENTORING

Maya Kittles (undergraduate)

- Recipient of NYU Dean’s Undergraduate Research Fund (\$1,250)

Tyler Sterle (Master’s thesis student)

- Recipient of the NYU Master-Mentorship Model Award (\$1,500)
- Now PhD student in Psychology, Fordham University

Andrea Zavala (Master’s student)

- Recipient of NYU Graduate Student Research Award (\$750)

Ellee Lucero (undergraduate)

- Recipient of NYU Dean’s Undergraduate Research Fund (\$1,250)

TEACHING

Introduction to Psychology (lecturer/course instructor)

Social Psychology (teaching assistant)

MA Thesis (teaching assistant)

Research Methods & Experience (teaching assistant)

Psychometric Theory (teaching assistant)

Personality Psychology (teaching assistant)

RESEARCH VISITS / WORKSHOPS

- 2026 **Visiting Researcher**, School of Management, Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich (Host: Prof. Martin Paul Fritze)

2025 **The Summer Institutes in Computational Social Science**, University of Pennsylvania
2024 **Global Research Fellow**, NYU Center in Prague

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Society for the Science of Motivation
Society for Affective Science
Society for Personality and Social Psychology
Association for Psychological Science

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

2025-2026 Social Psychology Department Speaker Series Organizing Committee, New York University
2024-2026 Annual NYU Master's Psychology Research Conference Organizing Committee, New York University
2024-2025 Social Psychology Program Cohort Representative, New York University
2021-2022 Volunteer, Student Peer Helping Program, Nanyang Technological University
May-Aug 2021 Intern, Singapore Prison Service
2019-2021 President of Chinese Debating Squad, Nanyang Technological University
2014-2015 Volunteer, Institute of Mental Health, Singapore

SKILLS

Research Methods: experiment, survey, focus group discussion, data mining, text analysis

Data Analysis: multiple regression, ANOVA, supervised and unsupervised machine learning, Bayesian data analysis, network analysis

Software: SPSS, R, Python, Tableau, SPSS Modeler, Orange, Adobe Photoshop